



EUROPEAN UNION
DELEGATION TO THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

The Ambassador

17 September 2026, Washington D.C.

A Message from Ambassador Jovita Neliupšienė
Ambassador of the European Union to the United States

Dear Fairfax County Public Schools Students and Community,

What helps a nation endure for 250 years?

As the United States commemorates its 250th anniversary, I invite you to participate in the **Alliances That Sustain America Essay Contest**, an opportunity to explore the enduring partnership between the United States and Europe and its importance throughout American history.

I am pleased that the Delegation of the European Union to the United States is partnering with Ryan Minton, Founder and President of the Langley World Affairs Club, on this student-led educational initiative. Together, we invite students across Fairfax County Public Schools to examine the history of the transatlantic relationship and consider how cooperation between the United States and Europe has contributed to peace, prosperity, innovation, and shared democratic values.

This essay contest invites you to explore the EU–U.S. alliance through a historical lens. You may focus on a particular period, event, or area of cooperation, or examine how the partnership has evolved over time to address common challenges and opportunities.

History is much more than a collection of names and dates. It helps us understand people, ideas, and relationships. The partnership between Europe and the United States has grown over generations, adapting to changing circumstances while remaining rooted in shared values and common interests. As you explore this history, I hope you will discover how international cooperation continues to shape our world and why strong partnerships remain important for future generations.

Like you, I was once a student with big questions about the world beyond my hometown. Growing up in Lithuania, I became curious about the past, different cultures, and how countries work together. That curiosity eventually led me to a career in diplomacy. Looking back, I realize that asking thoughtful questions, listening carefully, and learning from others have been among valuable lessons in my life.

Every meaningful discovery begins with a thoughtful question. I admire every student who chooses to take on a challenging question and pursue it through thorough research and careful investigation. Those habits will serve you well throughout your education and far beyond it.

Good luck. I look forward to celebrating the curiosity, creativity, and thoughtful work that this initiative inspires.

Yours sincerely,



Jovita Neliupšienė